

Because, because of, and so

Learner workbook

Give a reason and describe its result.

Understand the distinction

Because introduces a reason with a clause: because the bus was late. Because of introduces a noun phrase: because of the delay. So can introduce the result: The bus was late, so I walked.

In a simple standard-English sentence, choose one clear connection rather than because ... so A cause claim needs evidence; events happening together does not prove that one caused the other.

Compare the patterns

BECAUSE

I stayed home because I felt ill.

The reason is a clause.

BECAUSE OF

I stayed home because of a cold.

The reason is a noun phrase.

RESULT

I felt ill, so I stayed home.

So introduces what happened as a result.

Read each example. Explain what the highlighted choice means in context. Then cover the example and say a similar sentence.

Check your understanding

Write before looking at the answers. The guide gives a model answer and explains the choice. Other wording can be correct.

1. We stopped ____ the heavy rain.

2. Join with so: The shop was closed. We came back later.

3. Correct this: Because I was tired, so I went home.

Use it in your own life

Explain a recent decision with because or because of.

Self-check

Does your sentence express your intended meaning? Does its form follow the relevant pattern? Can a reader understand the context?

Try again

After checking the explanation, revise your sentence. Say it aloud or use it in a short conversation.

Answers and explanation

1. because of

The heavy rain is a noun phrase.

2. The shop was closed, so we came back later.

Put the result after so.

3. Because I was tired, I went home.

Alternatively: I was tired, so I went home.

One possible response

I took the bus because my bicycle needed a repair.

This is a model, not the only acceptable answer. Assess meaning, grammar, and context together.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-09.html